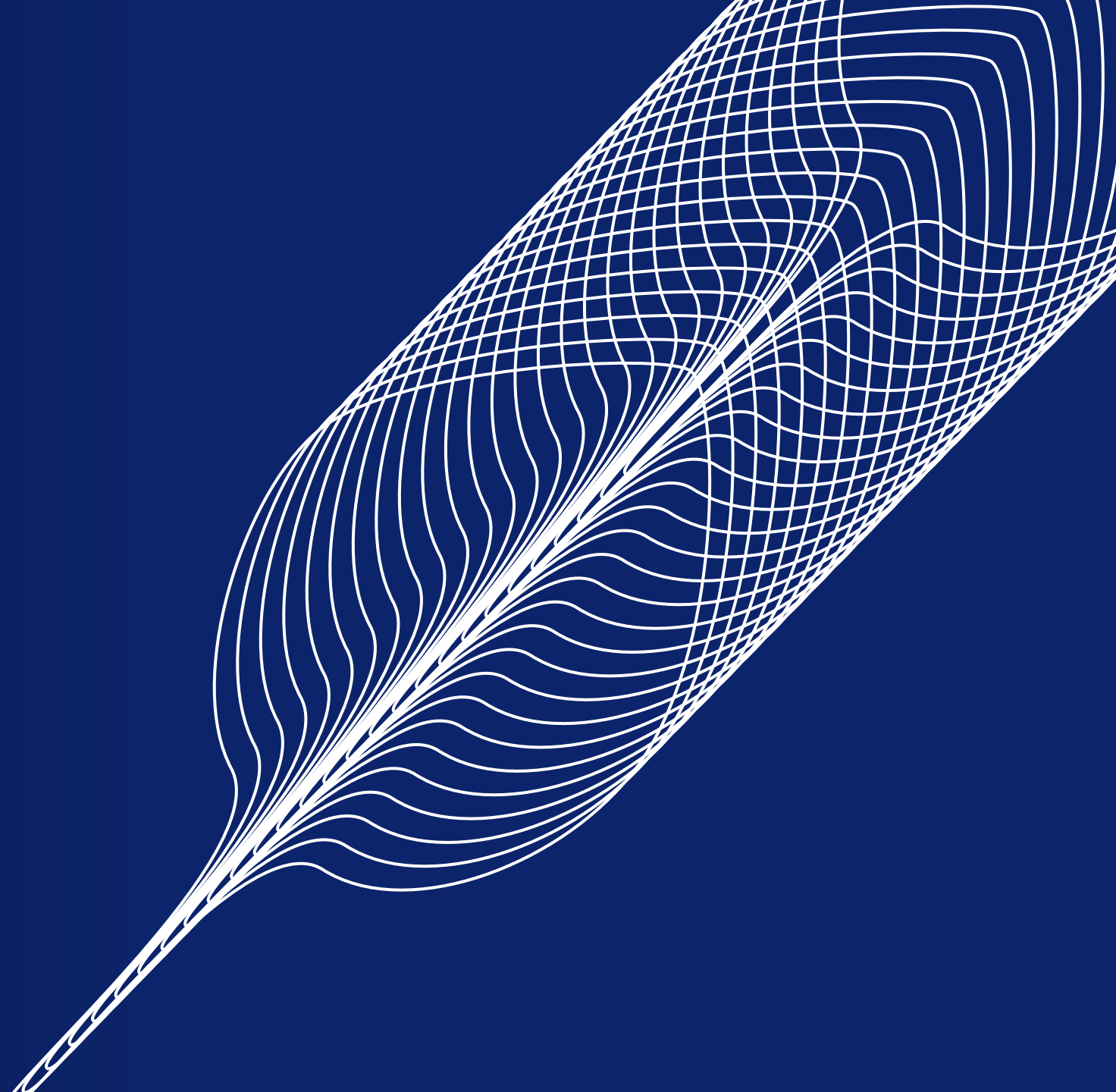
Hamilton
CONSULTING GROUP

What is Management Consulting?

October 22, 2026

8:00 pm, KJ 202





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GMP



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Partner

Structured Advice without the Decision

A friend says something feels wrong in their relationship and asks for help.

Your process:

1. Clarify the problem
2. Separate facts from reactions
3. Identify patterns and causes
4. Compare options, trade-offs, and risks

Your recommendations

“Here’s what I think is happening, and here are your strongest options”

You provide an objective recommendation. They decide.

What is Management Consulting?

The definition & function of consulting, what the work looks like, what a consulting career looks like, and the industry landscape.

Consulting Sells Clarity Under Uncertainty

Consultants are external advisors hired to structure ambiguity and inform high-stakes decisions.

Uncertainty

Profits are declining | How to enter a new market | Respond to a competitive threat

↓

Structured Analysis

Diagnose root cause | Quantify financial impact | Test strategic options

↓

Executive Recommendation

Clear position: “we recommend..." | Risks, tradeoffs, implementation path

“Consultants advise. Management decides.”

Engagements Vary by Scope

Engagement: a time-bound client project with a clearly defined problem, workplan, and deliverables

Defined Scope

- Clear problem statement with explicit boundaries and agreed upon deliverables

Fixed Timeline

- A few weeks to multiple months. Regular milestones and consistent check-ins.

Small Teams

- 2-6 consultants, heavy collaboration and ownership, strong feedback culture.

Executive Deliverables

- Recommendations to executives, presenting findings and way forwards.

Strategy

- Market entry
- Growth strategy
- Portfolio decisions
- PE diligence

Operation

- Cost reduction
- Pricing optimization
- Supply chain redesign
- Margin improvement

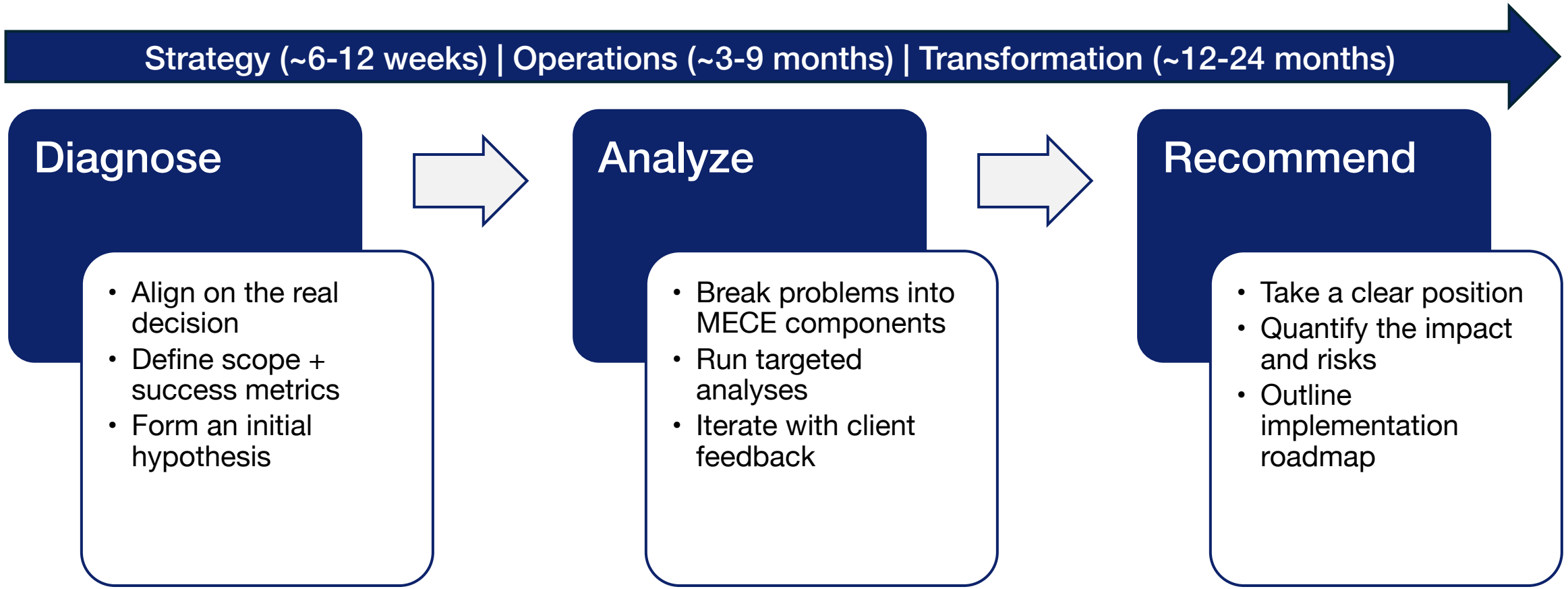
Transformation

- Org redesign
- Digital overhaul
- Turnaround strategy
- Culture shifts

Due Diligence

- Financial investigation
- Investment recs
- Operational diligence
- Commercial diligence

Work: Structured, Fast, and Collaborative



Careers in Consulting Accelerate Early

Early Responsibility

- Y1 Client Exposure
- Direct interactions with senior leadership
- Ownership of workstreams
- Small-team accountability

Skill Compression

- Hypothesis-driven thinking
- MECE approach
- Professional communication
- Quantitative rigor
- High-frequency feedback

Exit Optionality

- Private equity & investing
- Venture / startups
- Corporate strategy & leadership
- Public sector / policy
- Grad school / academia

Up or out culture is real.

Lifestyle and Benefits

Work-Life Balance

- 50-65 hours/week, varies.
- Weekends generally protected.
- Demanding weekdays, balanced by PTO and on-the-beach.

Comp and Benefits

- $100K+ starting base salary at many leading firms.
- Performance bonuses, signing bonuses, salary progression.
- Healthcare coverage, retirement, PTO.

Travel

- Monday-Thursday client-site model.
- Visit new places and environments.
- Firm-paid business travel; airline and premium hotel loyalty.

High demand, high reward.

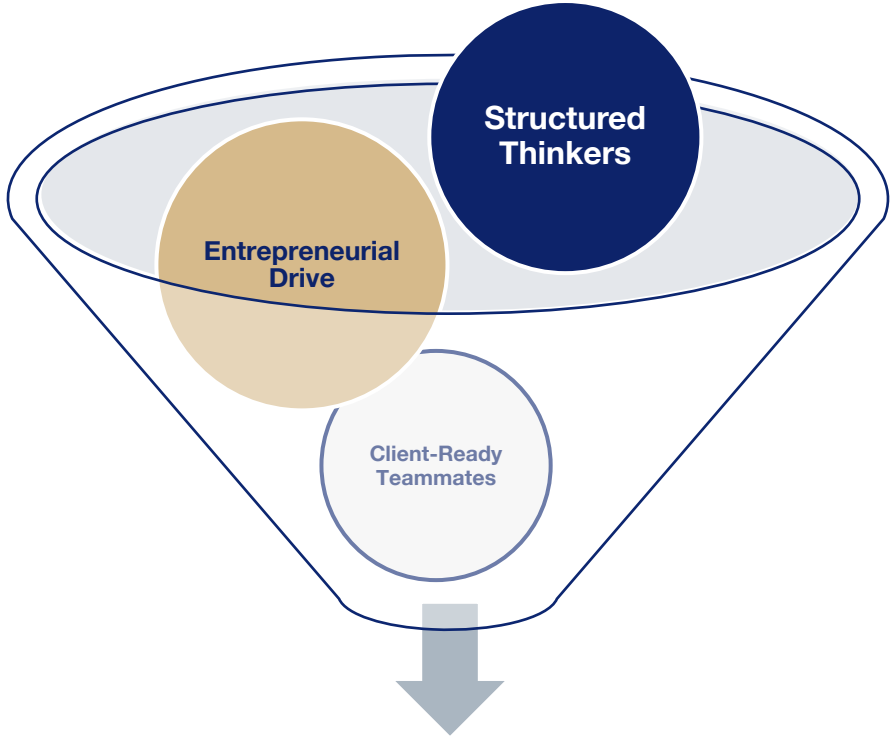
The Industry, Tiers and Designations



Who Thrives & Why Hamilton

What firms select for, the growing liberal arts edge, how Hamilton specifically positions you, and what resources there are here.

Selection is Structural



Problem Solving

Break ambiguity into components

Ownership

Take ownership and move the work forwards.

Collaboration

Internal and external communication that builds trust.

Bob Sternfels on Liberal Arts' Edge vs AI

15:44

- *Truly novel thinking*
- *Unique education background*
- *Creativity*



Hamilton Trains the Untrainable

Communication



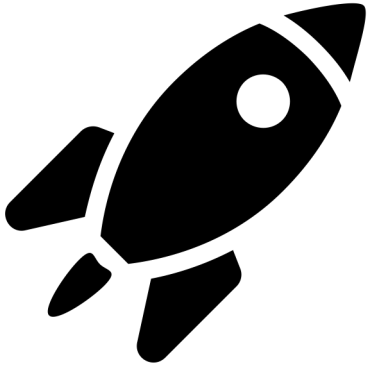
- Writing-intensives, etc.
- Seminar & discussions
- Collaboration through athletics, orgs, clubs

Intellectual Rigor



- Open curriculum
- Quantitative and qualitative
- Defending arguments

Drive

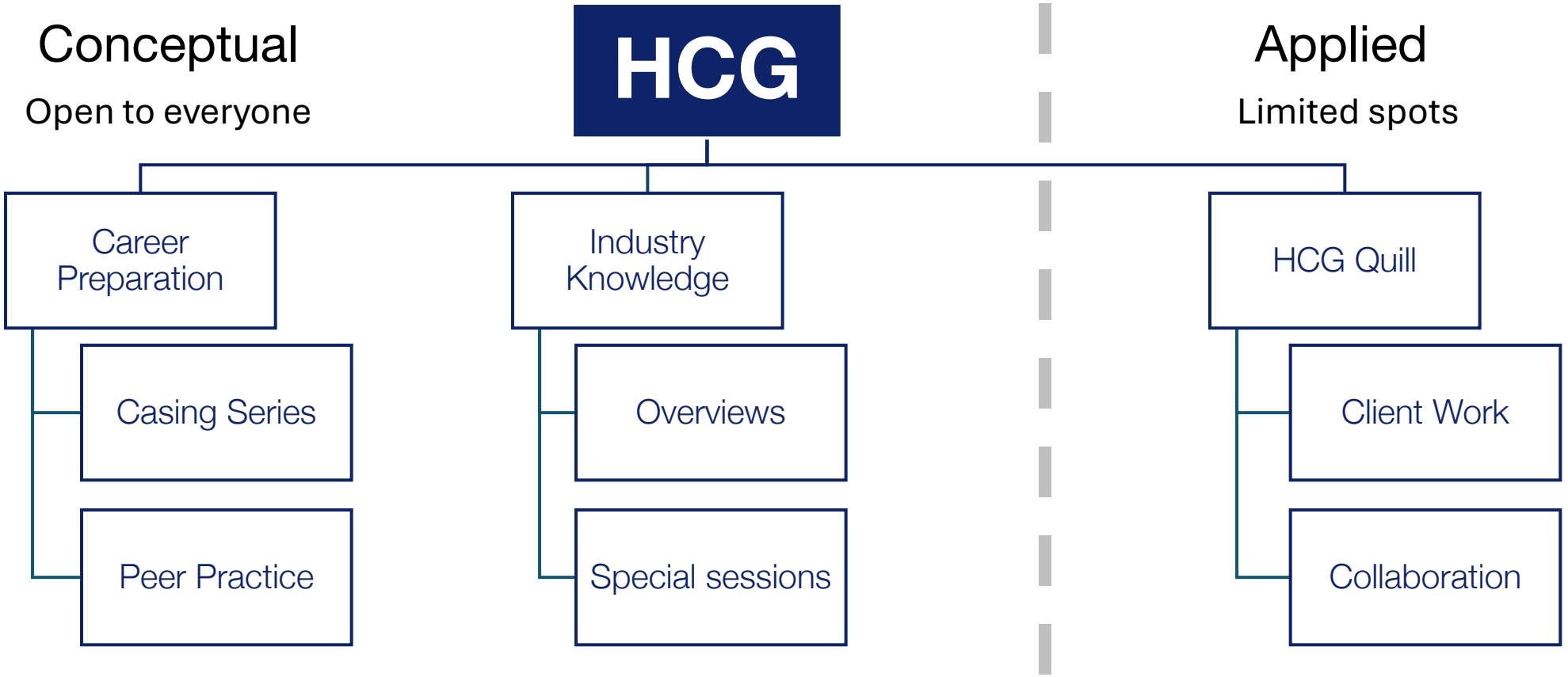


- Direct accountability
- Independent opportunities
- Leadership & impact

Institutional Infrastructure

Hamilton		
Alumni Connections	The Career Center Admissions Athletics	Hamilton Consulting Group

Hamilton Consulting Group



How do You Break In?

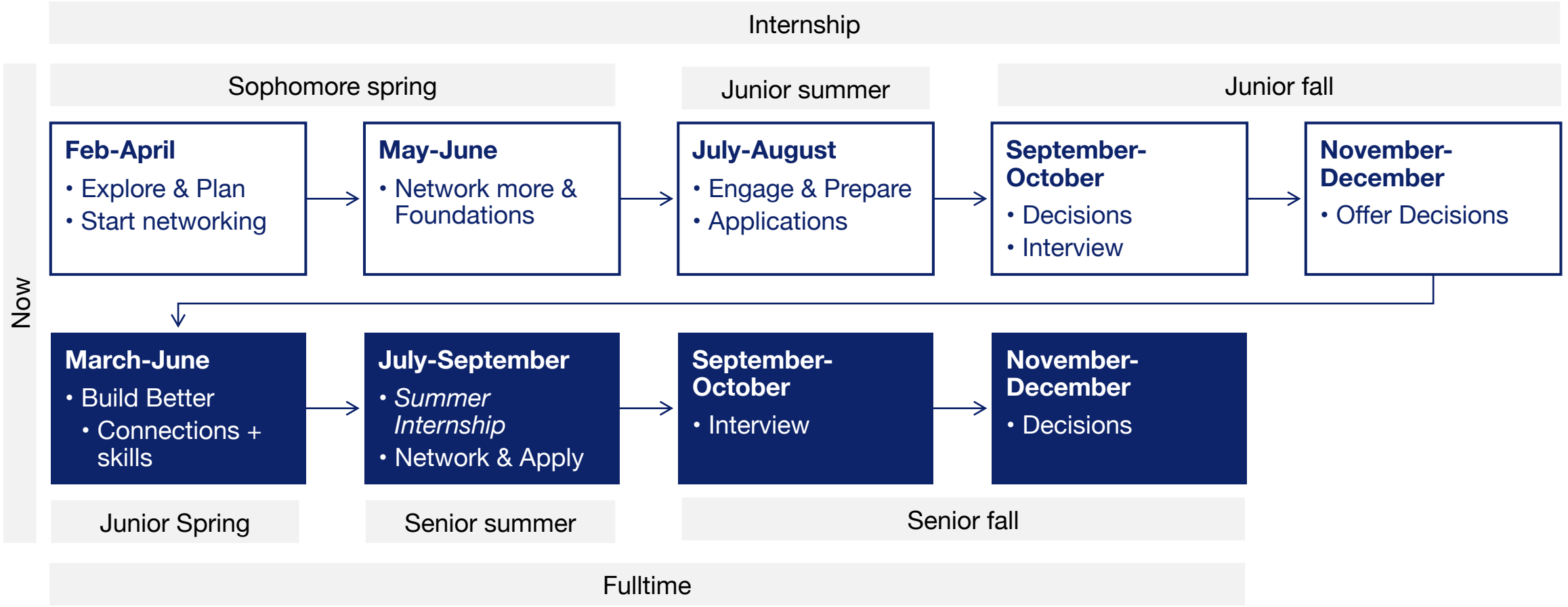
What access exists at Hamilton, recruiting timelines, experience, and the case interview.

Access Exists at Hamilton



The learning, tools, and opportunities are here — their value depends on you.

Recruiting is Timeline-Driven



Firms Select for Experience

Resume Signals (before)

What firms can see before meeting you.

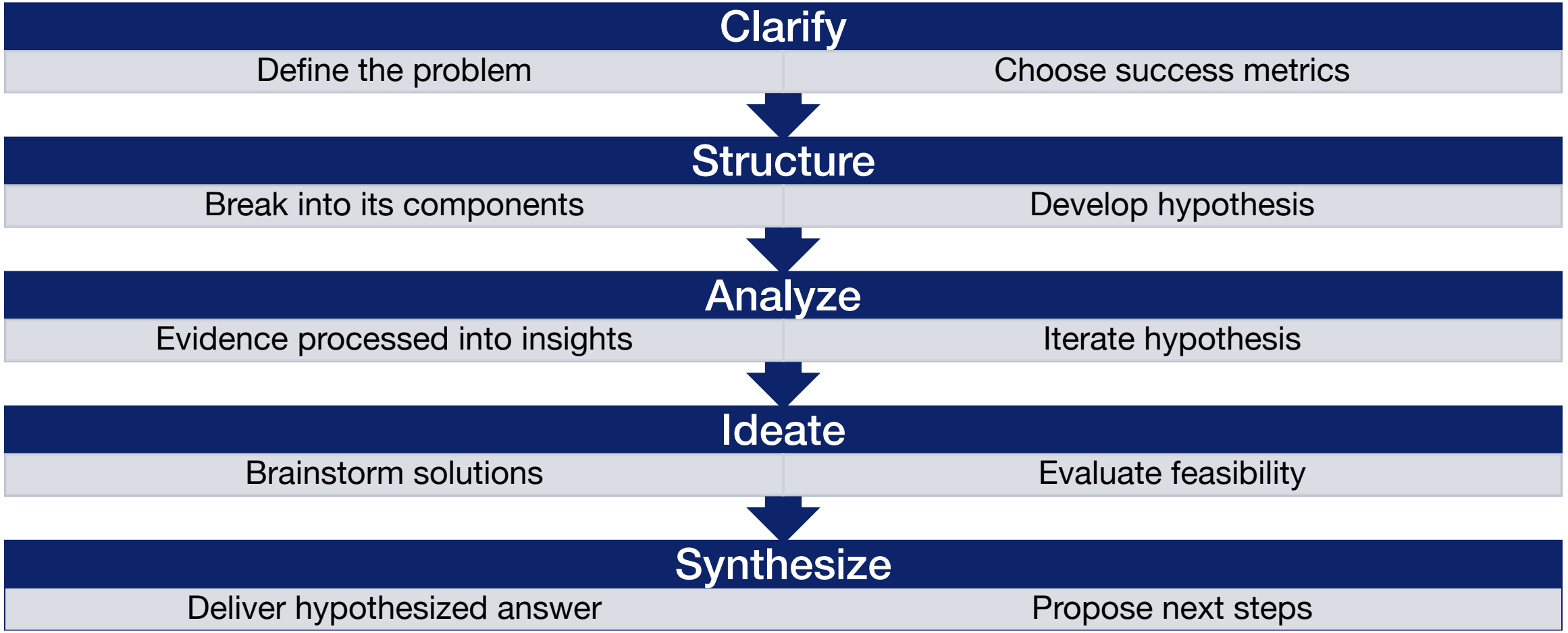
- Measurable, quantifiable impact (revenue, growth, efficiency)
- Leadership scope
- Selectivity / rigor
- Sustained commitment
- Brand associations

Experience Narratives (during)

What emerges once you speak in person

- Clear “why consulting” logic
- Consistent career arc
- Self-awareness
- Judgment under ambiguity
- Confidence without arrogance

The Case Interview.



Succes is Trained

Now

- Get involved in HCG
- Map target firms
- Review recruiting timelines

Next

- Draft 3-4 leadership/impact stories
- Reach out to alumni

Future

- Case interview reps
- Practice core skills
- Work on resumes and applications

Q&A

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